PROVISION SIGHT AFRICA

Community Outreach Visit Report

Kenya Union of the Blind | 27th March 2026

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1. Event Details

Date	27th March 2026
Venue	Kenya Union of the Blind, Nairobi, Kenya
Organiser	ProVision Sight Africa
Number of Attendees	15 visually impaired community members
Purpose	Product demonstration and user feedback collection for the ProVision app and smart glasses

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2. Background and Purpose

ProVision Sight Africa conducted a structured community outreach visit at the Kenya Union of the Blind on 27th March 2026. The objective of the visit was to engage directly with visually impaired end-users in a real-world setting, demonstrate the ProVision assistive technology system comprising the ProVision smart glasses and accompanying mobile application, and gather candid, first-hand feedback to inform ongoing product development.

The Kenya Union of the Blind provided an ideal setting for this engagement, bringing together members of the visually impaired community who represent ProVision's core target users. Their lived experience with visual impairment gave the team invaluable insight into the practical gaps, preferences, and challenges that technology must address to be genuinely useful in everyday life.

3. Programme of the Day

The visit was structured to allow for maximum interaction and open dialogue with the attendees. The day proceeded as follows:

- The session opened with a word of prayer, setting a respectful and community-centred tone for the engagement.
- The ProVision team introduced themselves and provided a brief overview of the ProVision project, its mission, and what the technology aims to achieve for the visually impaired community in Kenya.
- Attendees were invited to physically interact with the ProVision smart glasses and the mobile application. Each participant had the opportunity to wear the device, navigate their immediate environment, and experience the real-time audio feedback system.
- Following the hands-on testing session, participants shared their observations, suggestions, and concerns regarding both the hardware and the software components of the system.

4. User Feedback and Observations

A total of 15 visually impaired attendees participated in the testing and feedback session. The feedback collected covered a range of functional, technical, accessibility, and safety considerations. Below is a detailed account of the feedback provided, expanding on the key points raised by participants:

4.1 App Accessibility and Compatibility

- **Reading Page – TalkBack Compatibility:** Participants requested that the app's reading page be made fully compatible with TalkBack, Android's built-in screen reader. Several users who rely on TalkBack in their daily lives noted that a seamless transition between TalkBack and the ProVision app's own voice system would significantly improve usability. They emphasised that the two systems should work in harmony rather than conflict with each other.
- **Voice Selection – Multiple Voice Options:** Users requested the ability to select from a variety of voices within the app. Participants noted that having different voice options, including varying accents, genders, and speech speeds, would make the experience more personalised and comfortable for long-term, daily use.
- **Dark Mode Compatibility:** There was a strong request that the app's user interface, particularly any visual guide elements, be compatible with dark mode. Several attendees noted that those with partial sight often use dark mode to reduce eye strain, and the app should accommodate this preference.

4.2 Features and Functionality

- **More Descriptive Descriptions:** Participants asked for extended, more comprehensive descriptions of the environment and objects detected. Beyond simply naming an object or obstacle, users wanted richer contextual information. For example, understanding not just that a person is present, but also details such as their approximate body build.
- **Ask for More – In-depth Descriptions on Demand:** Users suggested that for longer, more detailed descriptions, the app should allow an interactive option to prompt for further information. Rather than delivering all information at once or cutting descriptions short, the app could ask the user: "Would you like more details?" This would give users greater control over the depth of information they receive.
- **Live Reading:** Several participants requested a live reading feature that allows the app to continuously and in real-time read out text detected in the environment, such as signs, labels, menus, and notices, without requiring the user to manually initiate a scan. This would be particularly useful in dynamic public environments.

- **Familiar Places Recognition:** Users expressed interest in the app being able to recognise familiar places and environments that the user has previously visited. Over time, the app could build a memory of frequently accessed spaces, such as home, workplace, or a regular shop, and provide contextually aware guidance when those places are detected again.
- **Front and Back Camera Integration:** Participants recommended integrating both the front-facing and rear-facing cameras of the smartphone into the app's functionality. Currently perceived as using only one camera, access to both cameras would expand the field of view and improve the detection of text, faces, and obstacles in different directions simultaneously.
- **Labelling of Objects and Environments:** Participants asked for object and environment labelling to be consistently and thoroughly implemented within the app. While some labelling already exists, users indicated that not all objects and spatial elements in their environment were being labelled clearly or reliably. Consistent labelling was highlighted as a core requirement for confident independent navigation.

4.3 Age Estimation Feature

- **Age Estimation:** A number of attendees suggested that the app should attempt to estimate the approximate age of people detected in the user's field of view. This feature would help visually impaired users better understand the social context of their surroundings, for instance, distinguishing between a child, a young adult, and an elderly person, which can be important in social interactions and navigation decisions.

4.4 Testing and Quality Assurance

- **More Testing Required:** Despite the generally positive reception of the product, participants noted that the app and device required more rigorous and extensive testing before they could be relied upon in everyday life. Some inconsistencies in performance were observed during the hands-on session, and attendees recommended continued iterative testing with real users in varied environments before a wider deployment.

- **Positive Comments – Limited Data Collected:** When participants were asked to share particularly positive aspects of the experience, the feedback in this area was limited, largely due to the session's focus on constructive criticism and improvement. This is not necessarily a negative signal but rather reflects the participants' desire to ensure the technology is refined and reliable before giving it their full endorsement.

4.5 Safety and Privacy Concerns

- **Security and Privacy Concerns – Recording Perception:** A significant concern raised by multiple attendees was the perception by members of the public that the smart glasses are recording them without consent. When users wear the ProVision glasses in public, bystanders may assume they are being filmed, which has reportedly caused discomfort and confrontation in some cases during prior use. Participants strongly recommended that ProVision address this through clear visual indicators on the device, public awareness, or design modifications that make the glasses appear less surveillance oriented.

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5. Summary and Next Steps

The outreach visit to the Kenya Union of the Blind was a productive and grounding engagement for the ProVision team. The 15 participants brought depth and authenticity to the feedback process, raising both technical and human-centred concerns that will directly shape the next phase of product development.

Key action areas identified from the session include:

- Integrating full TalkBack compatibility and ensuring smooth voice transitions within the app.
- Expanding voice customisation options for a more personalised user experience.

- Developing a live reading mode for continuous, real-time text detection.
- Building a familiar places memory feature for context-aware navigation.
- Enabling dual-camera support for wider environmental coverage.
- Improving and expanding object and environment labelling accuracy.
- Adding an optional age estimation feature for detected individuals.
- Conducting more extensive field testing across diverse environments and user profiles.
- Designing a strategy to address public privacy concerns related to the appearance of the smart glasses.

ProVision Sight Africa remains committed to co-creating this technology with the community it serves. The feedback from this session will be reviewed and prioritised by the product and engineering teams in the upcoming development sprint.

Report Compiled By:

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